

GRAMMAR PRACTICE GUIDE

Complete Study Guide with Exercises

Level Check 5-8

How to Use This Guide:

1. Read each grammar topic explanation carefully
2. Study the examples provided
3. Complete the 5 practice questions for each topic
4. Check your answers at the end of the guide
5. Review any topics where you made mistakes

1. Reported Speech (Direct to Indirect Speech)

Explanation

Reported speech (also called indirect speech) is when we tell someone what another person said without using their exact words.

Key Rules: • Change pronouns (I → he/she, you → I/we, etc.) • Backshift tenses (move one tense back in time) • Change time expressions (now → then, today → that day, yesterday → the day before) • Remove quotation marks • Use 'that' after the reporting verb (optional)

Common Tense Changes: • Present Simple → Past Simple (says → said) • Present Continuous → Past Continuous (is doing → was doing) • Present Perfect → Past Perfect (has done → had done) • Past Simple → Past Perfect (did → had done) • Will → Would • Can → Could

Example: Direct: "I am going to the store," she said. Reported: She said (that) she was going to the store.

Practice Questions

Question 1: Direct: "I love chocolate." What is the reported speech?

- a) She said she loves chocolate.

- b) She said she loved chocolate.
- c) She said she has loved chocolate.
- d) She says she loved chocolate.

Question 2: Direct: "We are leaving tomorrow," they said. What is the reported speech?

- a) They said they are leaving the next day.
- b) They said they were leaving tomorrow.
- c) They said they were leaving the next day.
- d) They said they will leave the next day.

Question 3: Direct: "I have finished my homework," Tom said. What is the reported speech?

- a) Tom said he finished his homework.
- b) Tom said he has finished his homework.
- c) Tom said he had finished his homework.
- d) Tom said he finishes his homework.

Question 4: Direct: "Can you help me?" she asked. What is the reported speech?

- a) She asked if I can help her.
- b) She asked if I could help her.
- c) She asked can I help her.
- d) She asked could I help her.

Question 5: Direct: "I will call you later," he said. What is the reported speech?

- a) He said he will call me later.
- b) He said he would call me later.
- c) He said he calls me later.
- d) He said he called me later.

2. Inversion (Inverted Word Order)

Explanation

Inversion means changing the normal word order in a sentence, usually putting the verb before the subject. This is used for emphasis or in formal/literary English.

Common Types of Inversion:

1. Negative Adverbials at the Beginning: When negative words (never, rarely, seldom, hardly, little, no sooner, not only) start a sentence, we invert the subject and auxiliary verb.

Normal: I have never seen such beauty. Inverted: Never have I seen such beauty.

2. "Little did" Structure: Normal: He understood little about the situation. Inverted: Little did he understand about the situation.

3. "Only" + Time Expression: Normal: I realized my mistake only then. Inverted: Only then did I realize my mistake.

4. "Not only... but also": Not only did she win the race, but she also broke the record.
5. Conditional Inversion (without 'if'): Normal: If I had known, I would have helped. Inverted: Had I known, I would have helped.

Practice Questions

Question 1: Normal: "She rarely goes to the gym." What is the inverted form?

- a) Rarely she goes to the gym.
- b) Rarely does she go to the gym.
- c) Rarely goes she to the gym.
- d) Rarely she does go to the gym.

Question 2: Normal: "I have never been so embarrassed." What is the inverted form?

- a) Never I have been so embarrassed.
- b) Never have I been so embarrassed.
- c) Never been I have so embarrassed.
- d) Never I been have so embarrassed.

Question 3: Normal: "He knew little about her plans." What is the inverted form?

- a) Little he knew about her plans.
- b) Little knew he about her plans.
- c) Little did he know about her plans.
- d) Little does he knew about her plans.

Question 4: Normal: "We realized the danger only after the accident." What is the inverted form?

- a) Only after the accident we realized the danger.
- b) Only after the accident did we realize the danger.
- c) Only after the accident realized we the danger.
- d) Only after the accident we did realize the danger.

Question 5: Normal: "If I were you, I would apologize." What is the inverted form?

- a) Were I you, I would apologize.
- b) I were you, would I apologize.
- c) Were you I, I would apologize.
- d) If were I you, I would apologize.

3. Conjunctions and Linking Words

Explanation

Conjunctions connect words, phrases, or clauses. Different conjunctions show different relationships between ideas.

Common Conjunctions:

1. CONTRAST (showing difference): • Although / Even though / Though = despite the fact that • However = but (more formal) • In spite of / Despite = regardless of (+ noun/gerund)

Examples: - Even though he was tired, he continued working. - She failed the test. However, she didn't give up. - Despite the rain, they went hiking.

2. CAUSE and EFFECT: • Because / Since / As = giving a reason • Due to / Because of = caused by (+ noun) • Therefore / Consequently / Thus = as a result • So that = in order to

Examples: - Since it was raining, we stayed home. - Due to bad weather, the flight was cancelled. - He studied hard; consequently, he passed the exam.

3. TIME: • When / While / As = during • After / Before • As soon as = immediately when • Until / Till = up to the time that

4. CONDITION: • If / Unless / Provided that / As long as

Practice Questions

Question 1: _____ he was fired from his job, he still has plenty of money.

- a) Even though
- b) Since
- c) Due to the fact that
- d) Consequently

Question 2: The roads were icy. _____, there were many accidents.

- a) Although
- b) However
- c) Consequently
- d) Despite

Question 3: _____ the bad weather, the concert was cancelled.

- a) Although
- b) Even though
- c) Due to
- d) However

Question 4: She studied all night _____ she could pass the exam.

- a) because
- b) so that
- c) although
- d) despite

Question 5: _____ being very tired, he decided to go for a run.

- a) Although
- b) However
- c) Despite

d) Because

4. Modal Verbs of Deduction (Past)

Explanation

Modal verbs of deduction are used to express how certain we are about something that happened in the past.

Structure: Modal + have + past participle

Levels of Certainty:

1. MUST HAVE (90-95% certain - strong positive deduction) = I'm almost sure this happened

Example: "He must have stolen the car." (The evidence strongly suggests he did it)

2. MIGHT/MAY/COULD HAVE (50% certain - possibility) = Perhaps this happened, perhaps not

Example: "She might have forgotten about the meeting."

3. CAN'T/COULDN'T HAVE (90-95% certain - strong negative deduction) = I'm almost sure this

didn't happen Example: "He couldn't have stolen it." (It's almost impossible)

4. SHOULD/UGHT TO HAVE (criticism or regret) = This was the right thing to do, but it didn't

happen Example: "You should have studied harder." (But you didn't)

5. SHOULDN'T HAVE (criticism) = This was wrong to do, but it happened Example: "You

shouldn't have lied to her."

Key Difference: • MUST HAVE = logical conclusion based on evidence • SHOULD HAVE = advice/criticism about what was right

Practice Questions

Question 1: Carlos, the gardener, _____ the car. He knew where the keys were and hasn't shown up to work ever since.

- a) must have stolen
- b) should have stolen
- c) couldn't have stolen
- d) shouldn't have stolen

Question 2: I can't find my wallet anywhere. I _____ it at the restaurant.

- a) must leave
- b) must have left
- c) should leave
- d) can't have left

Question 3: She got 100% on the test. She _____ very hard.

- a) should have studied
- b) can't have studied
- c) must have studied
- d) might studied

Question 4: You look exhausted. You _____ to bed earlier last night.

- a) must have gone
- b) should have gone
- c) couldn't have gone
- d) might go

Question 5: He _____ the meeting. He was in another country at that time.

- a) must have attended
- b) should have attended
- c) might have attended
- d) couldn't have attended

5. Future Perfect Continuous

Explanation

The Future Perfect Continuous tense describes an action that will continue up until a point in the future.

Structure: will have been + verb-ing

Usage: We use this tense to show that something will continue up to a specific time in the future, emphasizing the duration.

Formation: Subject + will have been + verb-ing

Examples: • "By this time next year, I will have been working for this company for three years." • "By December, she will have been studying English for six months." • "In 2025, they will have been living in London for ten years."

Time Expressions: • By [time] • By the time [clause] • By this time next [period] • For [duration]

Comparison with Other Future Forms: • Will be = simple future continuous (I will be working) • Will have to be = future obligation (I will have to be there) • Have been = present perfect continuous (I have been working) • Will have been = future perfect continuous (I will have been working)

Common Mistake: ✗ By next year, I will be an executive assistant for three years. ✓ By next year, I will have been an executive assistant for three years.

Practice Questions

Question 1: By this time next year, I _____ an executive assistant for this company for three years.

- a) will be
- b) will have to be
- c) have been
- d) will have been

Question 2: By the time she graduates, she _____ English for five years.

- a) will study
- b) will have been studying

- c) has been studying
- d) will be studying

Question 3: In June, they _____ in their new house for two years.

- a) will live
- b) have been living
- c) will have been living
- d) are living

Question 4: By next month, I _____ at this gym for a year.

- a) will exercise
- b) have been exercising
- c) will have been exercising
- d) am exercising

Question 5: By 2030, we _____ this car for fifteen years.

- a) will drive
- b) will have been driving
- c) have driven
- d) will be driving

6. Relative Pronouns (Who, Which, Where, Whom)

Explanation

Relative pronouns connect clauses and give more information about a noun.

Types of Relative Pronouns:

1. WHO - for people (subject) • "The woman who lives next door is a doctor." • Who = the person doing the action
2. WHOM - for people (object) - formal • "The man whom I met yesterday is my new boss." • Whom = the person receiving the action • In modern English, "who" often replaces "whom" in informal speech
3. WHICH - for things and animals • "The house which is by the lake was sold." • "I bought the book which you recommended."
4. WHERE - for places • "The restaurant where we had dinner was excellent." • "This is the city where I was born."
5. WHOSE - for possession • "The student whose book was lost is upset."
6. THAT - for people or things (informal) • "The book that I'm reading is fascinating."

Defining vs Non-defining Clauses: • Defining: Essential information (no commas) "The house which is by the lake was sold." • Non-defining: Extra information (use commas) "The house, which is by the lake, was sold."

Common Test Pattern: "The house, _____ is by the lake, was sold." Answer: which (not "where" because we're describing the house itself, not referring to it as a location)

Practice Questions

Question 1: The house, _____ is by the lake, was sold. We missed our opportunity.

- a) which
- b) where
- c) who
- d) whom

Question 2: The woman _____ called you is my sister.

- a) which
- b) where
- c) who
- d) whom

Question 3: This is the restaurant _____ we had our first date.

- a) which
- b) where
- c) who
- d) whom

Question 4: The doctor _____ I saw yesterday was very helpful.

- a) which
- b) where
- c) who
- d) whom

Question 5: The car _____ he bought is very expensive.

- a) which
- b) where
- c) who
- d) whose

7. Time Clauses (As soon as, When, While, etc.)

Explanation

Time clauses show when something happens in relation to another action.

Common Time Expressions:

1. AS SOON AS = immediately when • "As soon as I arrived home, it started raining." • Shows one action happens immediately after another
2. WHEN = at the time that • "When I was young, I lived in Paris." • General time reference
3. WHILE = during the time that (usually with continuous tenses) • "While I was cooking, the phone rang." • Two actions happening at the same time

4. AFTER = following in time • "After he finished his homework, he watched TV."
5. BEFORE = earlier than • "Before you leave, please turn off the lights."
6. UNTIL/TILL = up to the time that • "Wait here until I come back."
7. SINCE = from a point in the past until now • "I've been waiting since 9 AM."
8. BY THE TIME = not later than • "By the time we arrived, the movie had started."

Important Rule: In time clauses referring to the future, we use PRESENT tense (not future tense)!

✗ As soon as I will arrive, I will call you. ✓ As soon as I arrive, I will call you.

Context Clue: "He hadn't slept for 2 consecutive days; that's why, _____ we arrived home, he fell asleep." This shows immediate action → use "as soon as"

Practice Questions

Question 1: He hadn't slept for 2 consecutive days; that's why, _____ we arrived home, he fell asleep.

- a) as soon as
- b) now
- c) lately
- d) while

Question 2: _____ I finish my work, I will go to the gym.

- a) During
- b) When
- c) While
- d) Since

Question 3: _____ she was studying, her phone rang.

- a) As soon as
- b) After
- c) While
- d) Until

Question 4: Please wait _____ I return.

- a) while
- b) as soon as
- c) when
- d) until

Question 5: _____ you see her, please give her this message.

- a) While
- b) During
- c) When

d) Until

8. Past Tenses (Simple, Continuous, Perfect)

Explanation

Different past tenses show different relationships between past actions.

1. PAST SIMPLE: • Completed action in the past • "I visited Paris last year." • "She left at 6 PM."
2. PAST CONTINUOUS (was/were + verb-ing): • Action in progress at a specific time in the past • "I was sleeping when you called." • Background action interrupted by another action
3. PAST PERFECT (had + past participle): • Action completed before another past action • "I had finished dinner before they arrived." • Shows which action happened first
4. PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS (had been + verb-ing): • Action continuing up to a point in the past • "She had been working for 5 hours when I saw her."

Context Clues for Past Perfect: • "The week before we _____ for our trip" → Need past perfect or past simple • Time expressions: before, after, by the time, already, just

Choosing the Right Tense: Question: "I had lost my passport the week before we _____ for our trip to the USA."

Analysis: • "The week before" = earlier time reference • The losing happened BEFORE the leaving • We need simple past for "leaving" because it's the later action • Answer: "left" (past simple)

Common Patterns: • had + past participle ... before ... past simple • past simple ... after ... past perfect • by the time + past simple, past perfect

Practice Questions

Question 1: I had lost my passport the week before we _____ for our trip to the USA.

- a) were leaving
- b) left
- c) leave
- d) would leave

Question 2: She _____ for two hours when I finally arrived.

- a) waited
- b) was waiting
- c) had been waiting
- d) has waited

Question 3: By the time we got to the station, the train _____.

- a) left
- b) was leaving
- c) had left
- d) leaves

Question 4: I _____ TV when the doorbell rang.

- a) watched
- b) was watching
- c) had watched
- d) have watched

Question 5: After she _____ her homework, she went out to play.

- a) finished
- b) was finishing
- c) had finished
- d) finishes

Answer Key

1. Reported Speech (Direct to Indirect Speech)

- 1. b)
- 2. c)
- 3. c)
- 4. b)
- 5. b)

2. Inversion (Inverted Word Order)

- 1. b)
- 2. b)
- 3. c)
- 4. b)
- 5. a)

3. Conjunctions and Linking Words

- 1. a)
- 2. c)
- 3. c)
- 4. b)
- 5. c)

4. Modal Verbs of Deduction (Past)

- 1. a)
- 2. b)
- 3. c)
- 4. b)
- 5. d)

5. Future Perfect Continuous

- 1. d)
- 2. b)

3. c)

4. c)

5. b)

6. Relative Pronouns (Who, Which, Where, Whom)

1. a)

2. c)

3. b)

4. d)

5. a)

7. Time Clauses (As soon as, When, While, etc.)

1. a)

2. b)

3. c)

4. d)

5. c)

8. Past Tenses (Simple, Continuous, Perfect)

1. b)

2. c)

3. c)

4. b)

5. c)